

General Lit.





About the Course

Accessible texts such as Charlotte's Web help students grow the delight of reading for themselves.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 3



Placement & Combining Tips

Selections in General Literature are chosen to allow students to begin taking turns reading with their teacher and/or entirely by themselves (depending on reading level). If combining with younger students, make sure emerging readers still have space to practice reading somewhere in their lessons.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
3	General Lit.: Grade 3 1 time/week 15 min	Charlotte's Web Heart of a Samurai

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 3				
	General Lit.: Grade 3	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12	Lit./Mythology: Grade 3	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Literature: Grade 3

☐ Grade 3 should write a narration every couple of weeks from the term's reading, or write a part and tell the rest. The video "Tips for Transitioning from Oral to Written Narration" can be found in the Quick Links. As indicated in the video, students who are not yet secure with penmanship are not yet ready for written narration. In these cases, students may continue with oral and/or illustrated narrations only. Continue penmanship, but instead of written narrations, use the time to have students work on skills that will better support their development, such as climbing on trees or playground equipment, doing household chores, working with clay or dough, and doing mazes and dot-to-dot activities.

☐ As desired, plan for a read-aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

General Lit.: Grade 3

Term 3 (Heart of a Samurai): You have a few options for how to read this book. If you follow the page numbers listed in the lesson plan, you will finish parts one and two of the book (out of five). Scheduling this book in term three means students have the rest of the summer to finish the book if they would like to. However, reading pace can vary greatly at this age (or if being read aloud), and it's also fine to set a timer for 10-15 minutes of reading (allowing a few minutes for a verbal narration).

Homeschool families may choose to listen to this book on audiobook in the afternoons or in the car, which may help you finish the book during the term. If you choose this option, listen to 3-4 chapters per week to finish the book. Another option is to read a chapter or two a few afternoons/evenings a week if you'd like to finish the book during the term. Co-ops may want to assign a few chapters for home and then narrate and discuss the book during school hours. Any of these options is fine, and it's also ok if you don't finish the book, although we think you will want to—it's a fascinating story!



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Lit.: Grade 3



Charlotte's Web



Heart of a Samurai



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Transitioning from Oral to Written Narration](#)
- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



General Lit.: Grade 3

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something that the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Optional: use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 1

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ INTRO

Look at the cover of the book. Can you guess what this story will be about? Let's see if you're right!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.I

- What did you think of what happened?

WEEK 2 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 2

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.II-III p.8-16 "Fern loved Wilbur" - "no swims."

WEEK 3 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 3

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.III p.16-24 "One afternoon" - "he lay down."

- Do you think the goose gave Wilbur good advice? Why?

WEEK 4 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 4

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.IV

- What did you think of Wilbur's schedule?
- Who do you think will be Wilbur's friend?

WEEK 5 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 5

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ INTRO

What do you think makes a good friend?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.V

- What do you think of Charlotte so far?

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 6 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 6

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VI

- What do you think of Templeton?

WEEK 7 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 7

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VII-VIII

WEEK 8 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 8

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.IX

- Did you learn any new words in today's chapter?
- Do you think Charlotte has a plan yet?

WEEK 9 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 9

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.X

WEEK 10 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 10

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XI

- What did you think of Charlotte's trick?

WEEK 11 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 11

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore

General Lit.: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1	
Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 12 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Charlotte's Web	

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 13

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off with the story last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XII

WEEK 2 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 14

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ INTRO

What does "radiant" mean?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XIII p.92-101 "Far into the night" - "Tell me a story!"

- What word would you have chosen next?

WEEK 3 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 15

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XIII-XIV p.102-107 "So Charlotte" - "in the village."

WEEK 4 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 16

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XIV-XV p.107-117 "Dr. Dorian had" - "hold her eggs."

WEEK 5 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 17

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XVI p.118-126 "The night before" - "kill that pig."

- What do you think will happen next?

WEEK 6 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 18

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

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Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XVI-XVII p.126-137 "Wilbur heard" - "fell asleep."

WEEK 7 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 19

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XVIII

- What do you think Charlotte is making?

WEEK 8 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 20

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XIX

WEEK 9 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 21

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XX

WEEK 10 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 22

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XXI

WEEK 11 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 23

Materials: Charlotte's Web

→ INTRO

What made Charlotte such a great friend to Wilbur? What are good friends like?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XXII

- What did you think of the end of the story?

General Lit.: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

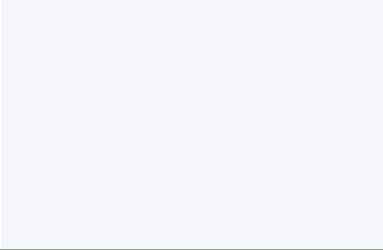
WEEK 12 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Charlotte's Web



General Lit.: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 25

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ INTRO

In 1841, a real fourteen-year-old Japanese fisherman named Manjiro survived a shipwreck and set in motion one of history's most unlikely adventures. At a time when Japan's borders were sealed to all outsiders, this humble fisherman's son crossed oceans and cultures. Heart of a Samurai is a work of historical fiction, drawing on the documented events of Manjiro's life to bring to life this extraordinary true story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

See Planning & Prep for alternate reading schedules. The pages listed will complete sections one and two of the book during the term.
Ch.1 p.1-8

→ LOCATE (OPTIONAL)

Look for Shikoku, Japan, on a map or globe.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Shikoku, Japan

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a helpful glossary of terms on p.283. If students have not been introduced to a glossary before and/or will be reading this book on their own, this is a good opportunity to point out how a glossary works. Remind students that they do not need to look up every word they do not know—most will make sense in context and will not be vital to the story. However, the glossary is available if there are words they (or you) would like to learn the meanings of.

Teachers may also want to read the historical notes on p.278-281 and share parts with students throughout the term as time allows.

WEEK 2 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 26

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ RECAP

What has happened so far in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 p.9-22

- Why does Manjiro want to be a Samurai? Why is he told he cannot?
- Why does the crew think they cannot go back to Japan?

WEEK 3 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 27

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ RECAP

What was Bird Island like?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3 p.26-36

- Why did Manjiro want to learn the "Barbarians'" language?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Image Link: Hiroshige Artwork

WEEK 4 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 28

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ RECAP

What were some of the new things Manjiro experienced on board in our last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

General Lit.: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Ch.4 p.37-50

- What do you think Manjiro is feeling during the whale hunt?

WEEK 5 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 29

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ RECAP

What happened during "the hunt" so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.51-57

- Compare what is said about whaling in Japan to what Manjiro experiences.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Last Remaining Wooden Whaling Ship from 1841

WEEK 6 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 30

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ RECAP

What happened once the whale was captured?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.58-65

- Why was Manjiro amazed and surprised after having tea with the captain?

WEEK 7 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 31

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ RECAP

What did Manjiro learn from the captain in our last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7-8 p.66-78

- What choice would you make if you were in Manjiro's situation?

WEEK 8 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 32

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ RECAP

What choice does Manjiro need to make?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-10 p.79-89

King Kamehameha mentioned in the text would have actually been King Kamehameha III (the third). He was the longest-reigning ruler in Hawai'i (called the Sandwich Islands in the book). Hawaii would not become a state for more than 100 years after these events (1959).

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Image Link: King Kamehameha III Statue

• EXTRA HELPING

In Heart of the Samurai, Manjiro knows missionaries were forced out of Japan, then later sees missionaries in Hawaii banning native dancing. What do these two examples teach us about how we should and should not approach sharing our faith with other cultures?

General Lit.: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 9 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 33

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ RECAP

What was happening to Manjiro when we left off?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11-12 p.90-102

- What do you think happened to Jolly? What do you think Manjiro should do about the lost watch?

WEEK 10 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 34

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ RECAP

What happened after the ship took sail in our last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13-14 p.103-115

- How is the watch recovered?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

John Manjiro's Story

Compare the character traits of Captain Whitfield to those of his crew and to Manjiro.

WEEK 11 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 35

Materials: Heart Of A Samurai

→ CATCH UP

Catch up reading (or continue the story). We hope you will continue reading the rest of Manjiro's story in your free time!

WEEK 12 15m General Lit.: Grade 3 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Heart of a Samurai

General Lit.: Grade 3

Examination

- Term 1** · Charlotte's Web: Tell about or illustrate one of the animals on the farm.
- Term 2** · Charlotte's Web: Tell about or illustrate one of your favorite parts of the book.
- Term 3** · Manjiro faces many difficulties in Heart of a Samurai. Choose two challenges that Manjiro faces and explain how he responds to each one. What do his responses tell us about the kind of person he is?